NOTES

BRIEFING FOR CITY COUNCIL · **GROUP 3**

260 menu items per container

Serving size **one dot**

Would you like sugar with that?

The council is weighing a fast-food ban. A ban treats all 260 menu items the same. We read the nutrition facts of every one to see where the problem actually sits. **Spoiler: 150 of them are not the problem.**

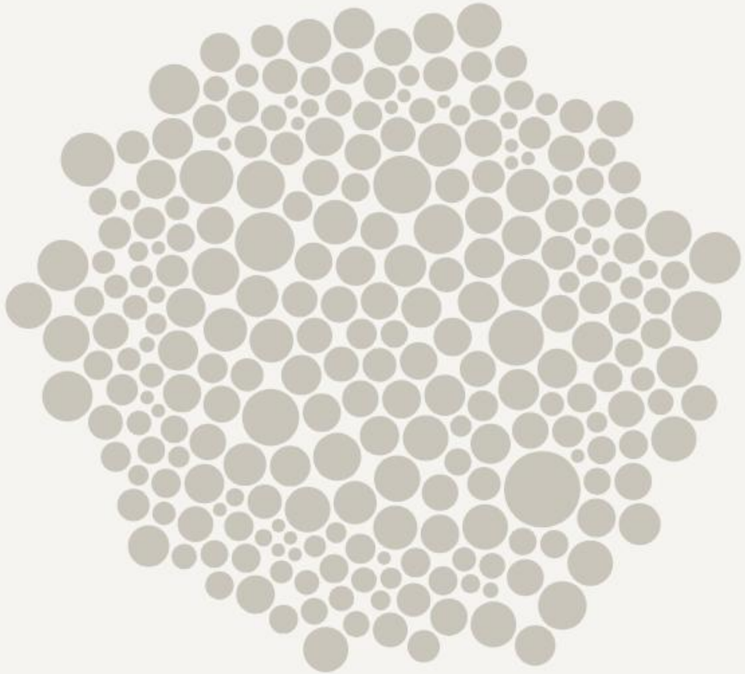
Menu items analysed **260**

`A blanket ban removes 260 items. The data flags 110.`

HOW TO READ

Each dot is one menu item. Bigger dot, more calories.

IE IMBA Data Fluency · Final group assignment. Use the arrow keys or a clicker to move through the story.



260 items. Where does the problem sit?

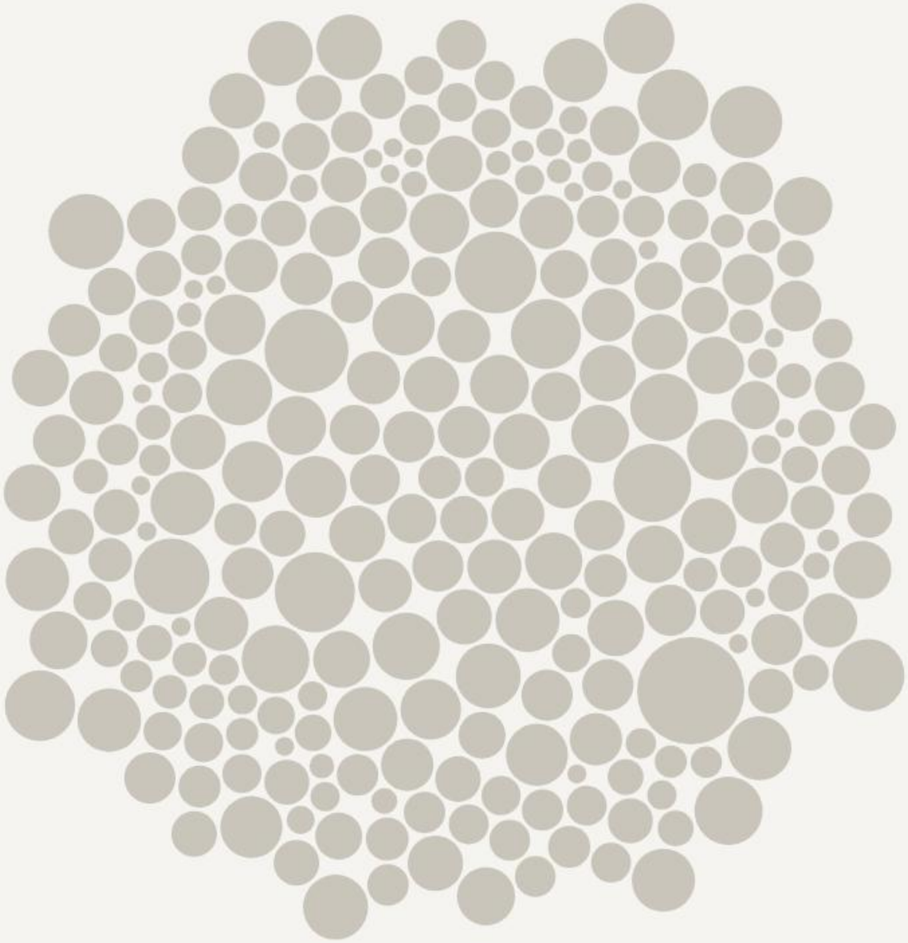
Data: Nutrition Facts for McDonald's Menu (Kaggle, US menu, 260 items). Sugar limit: WHO guideline, under 10% of energy, about 50g on 2,000 kcal.

PART 1 OF 3 · THE MENU

The menu.

260 items, one dot each. Before anyone bans a menu, we should know what is on it.

PRESENTER 1 · 4 SLIDES



260 menu items

One dot each. Bigger dot, more calories.

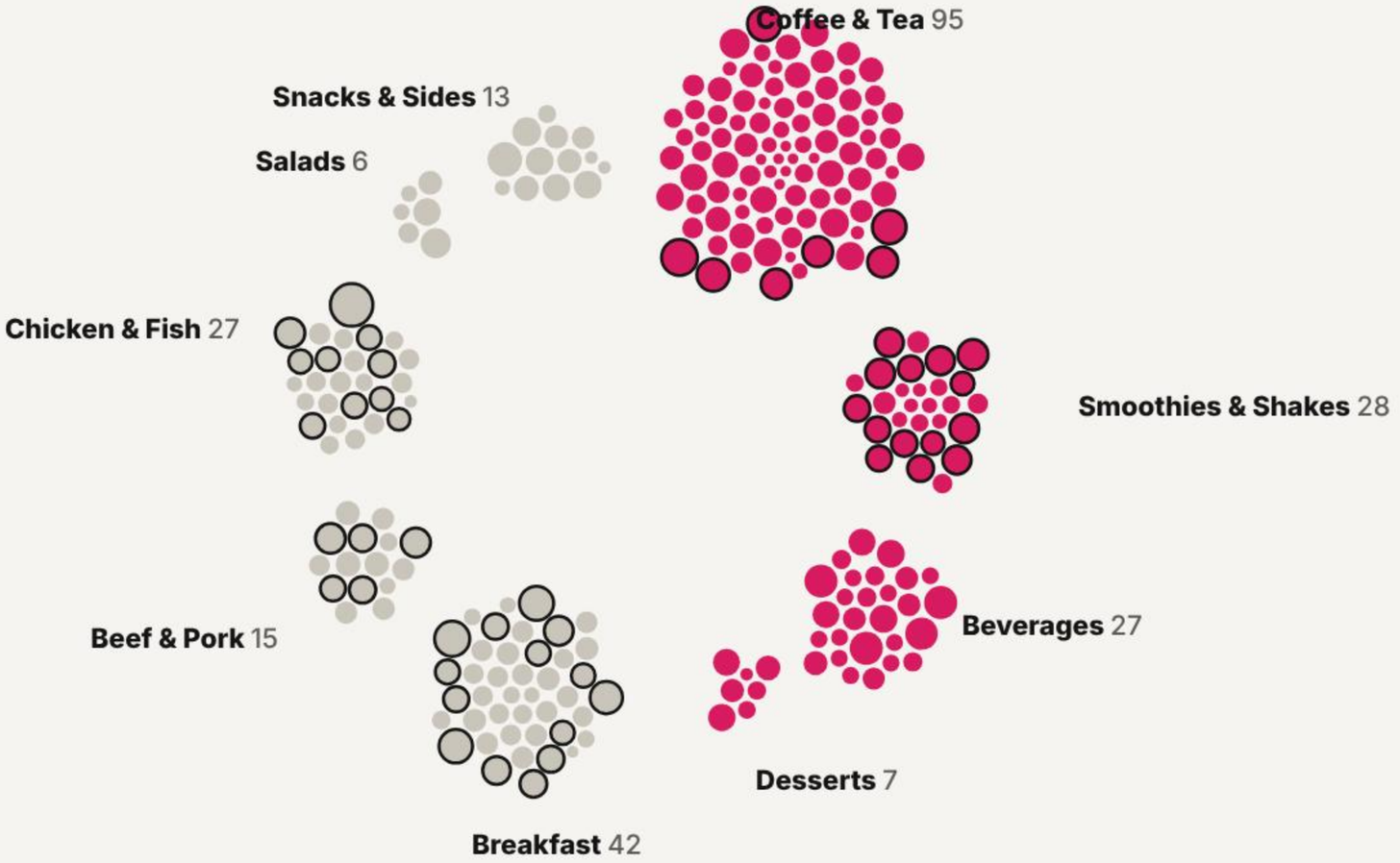
Six in ten menu items are drinks or desserts

157 of the 260 items are coffees, sodas, shakes or desserts. 21 of them carry more calories than a Big Mac.

Drinks & desserts **60%**

KEY

- Drinks & desserts
- Food
- More calories than a Big Mac (530)



all 260 dots are in our dashboard →

Data: Nutrition Facts for McDonald's Menu (Kaggle, US menu, 260 items). Sugar limit: WHO guideline, under 10% of energy, about 50g on 2,000 kcal.

NOTES

NOTES

21 drinks and desserts out-calorie a Big Mac

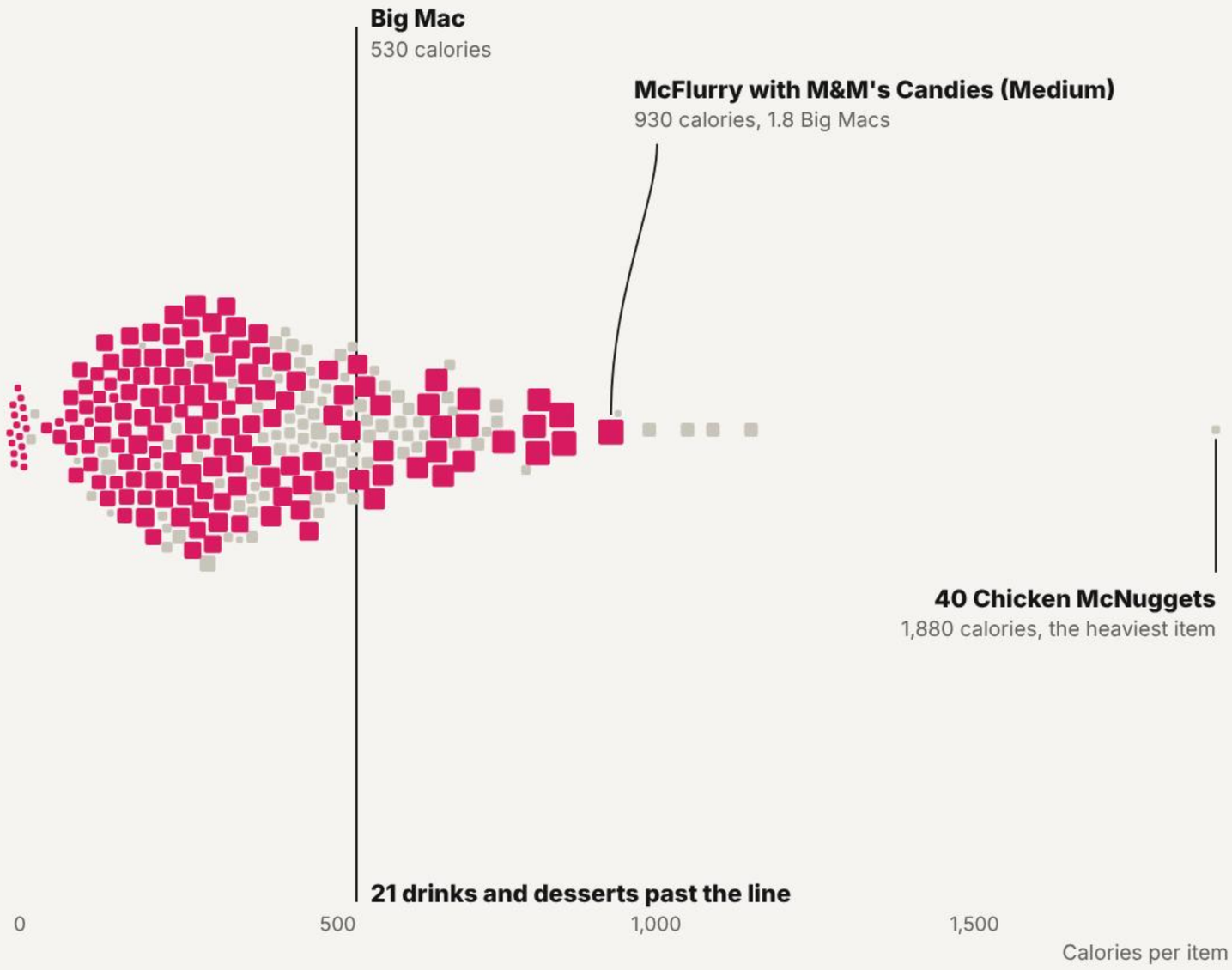
A Big Mac is 530 calories. A large chocolate shake is 850. The heaviest drink on the menu, a medium McFlurry, is 930.

Drinks heavier than a Big Mac **21**

KEY

- Drinks and desserts
- Food
- Big Mac, 530 calories

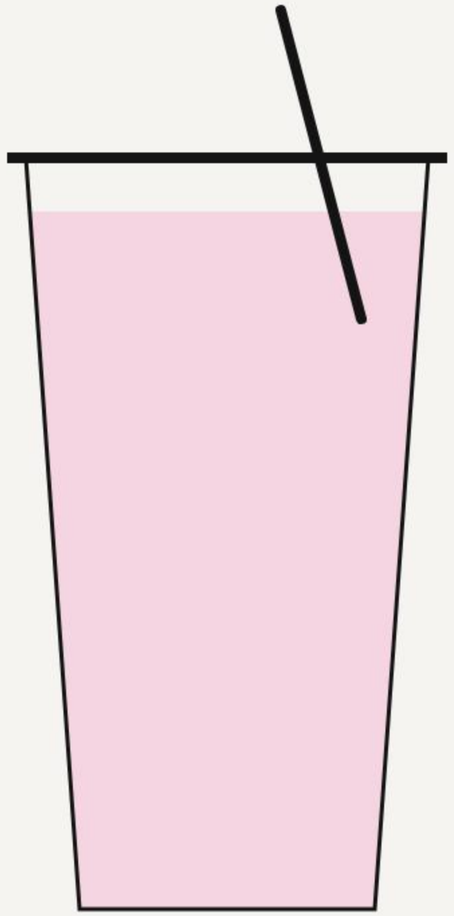
Each square is one menu item, placed by its calories. Bigger square, more sugar.



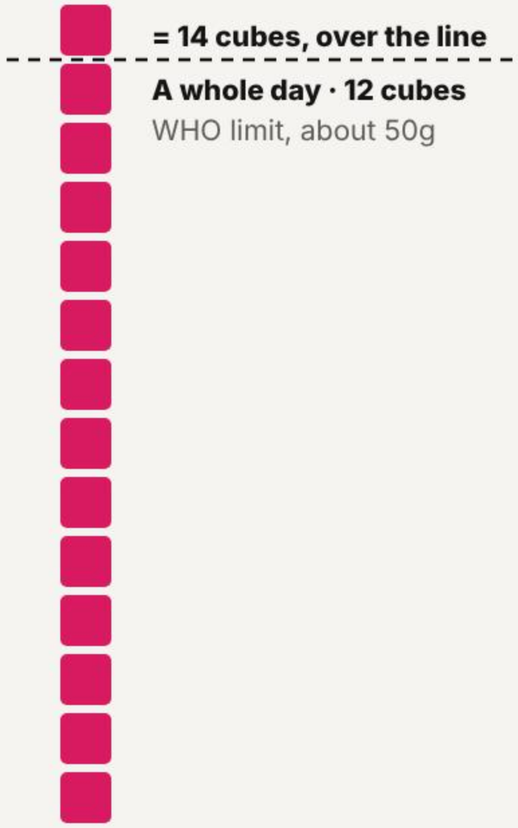
Data: Nutrition Facts for McDonald's Menu (Kaggle, US menu, 260 items). Sugar limit: WHO guideline, under 10% of energy, about 50g on 2,000 kcal.

Sugar.

One medium Coke is 14 sugar cubes. A whole day's limit is 12. The problem is in the cup.



One medium Coke
55g of sugar · 200 calories



1 cube = 4g

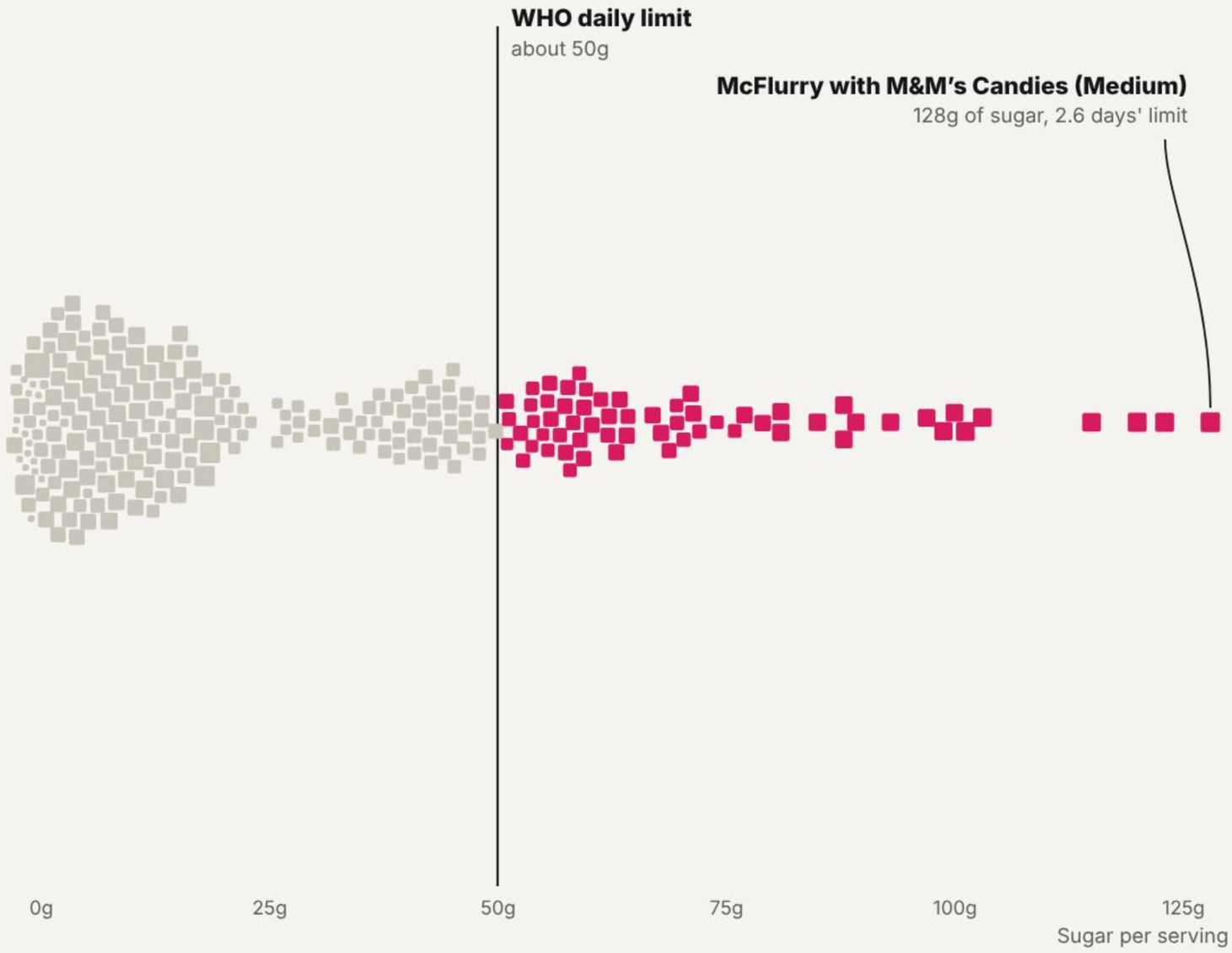
Every item over the daily sugar limit comes in a cup

62 items pass the WHO limit of about 50g in a single serving: shakes, McFlurries, sodas and sweet coffees. The sweetest food item has 32g.

Items over 50g of sugar **62**

KEY

- Over 50g of sugar
- Under 50g
- Bigger square, more calories



Data: Nutrition Facts for McDonald's Menu (Kaggle, US menu, 260 items). Sugar limit: WHO guideline, under 10% of energy, about 50g on 2,000 kcal.

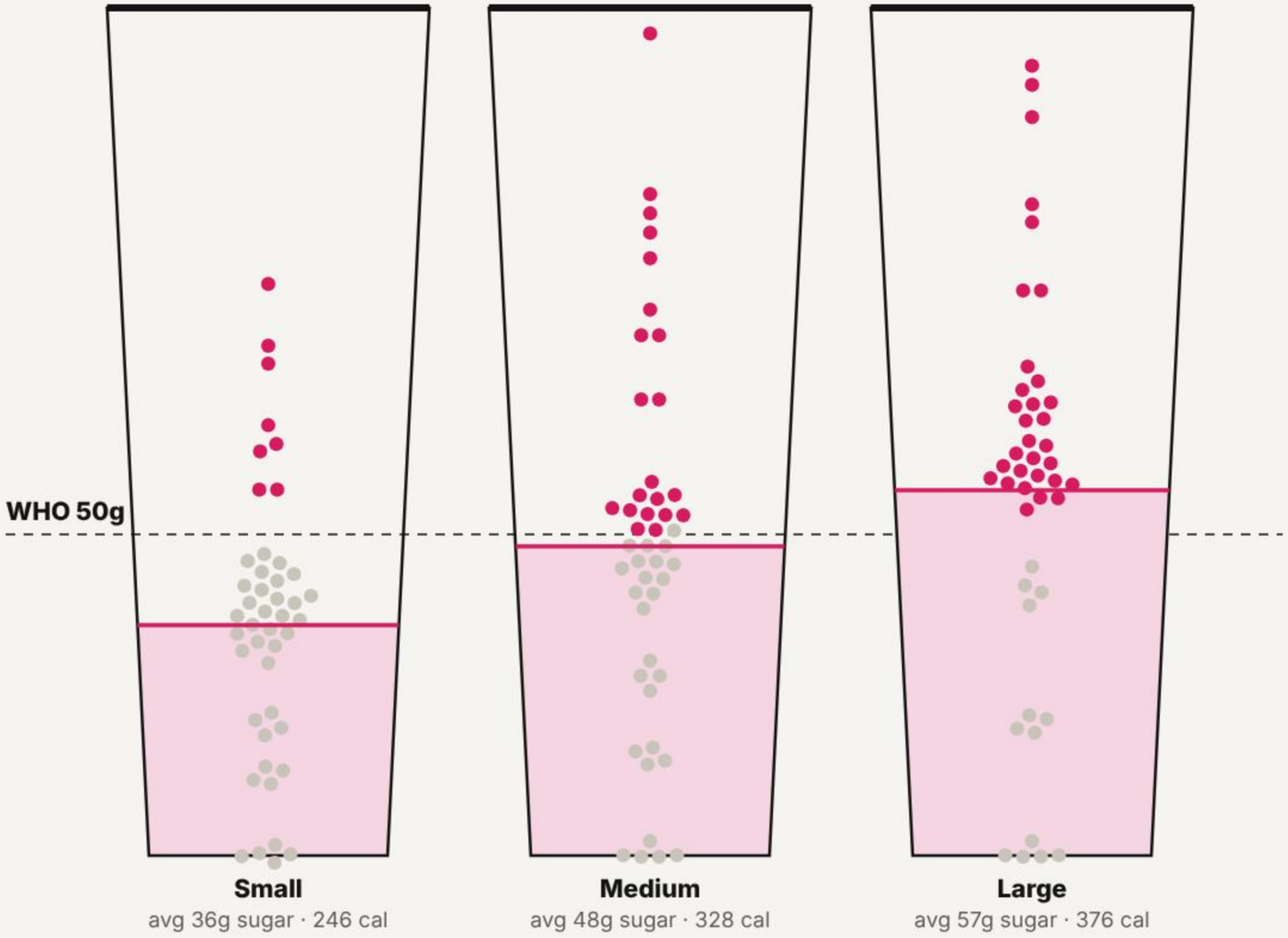
Each size up adds about 10g of sugar

Across 136 drinks sold in three sizes, the average Small has 36g of sugar, the Medium 48g and the Large 57g. The average Large is over the daily limit on its own.

Large vs Small **+21g**

KEY

- Over 50g of sugar
- Under 50g
- Fill line: average sugar per size. **Read the line, not the pink area.**



Data: Nutrition Facts for McDonald's Menu (Kaggle, US menu, 260 items). Sugar limit: WHO guideline, under 10% of energy, about 50g on 2,000 kcal.

Shakes and coffees carry the most sugar

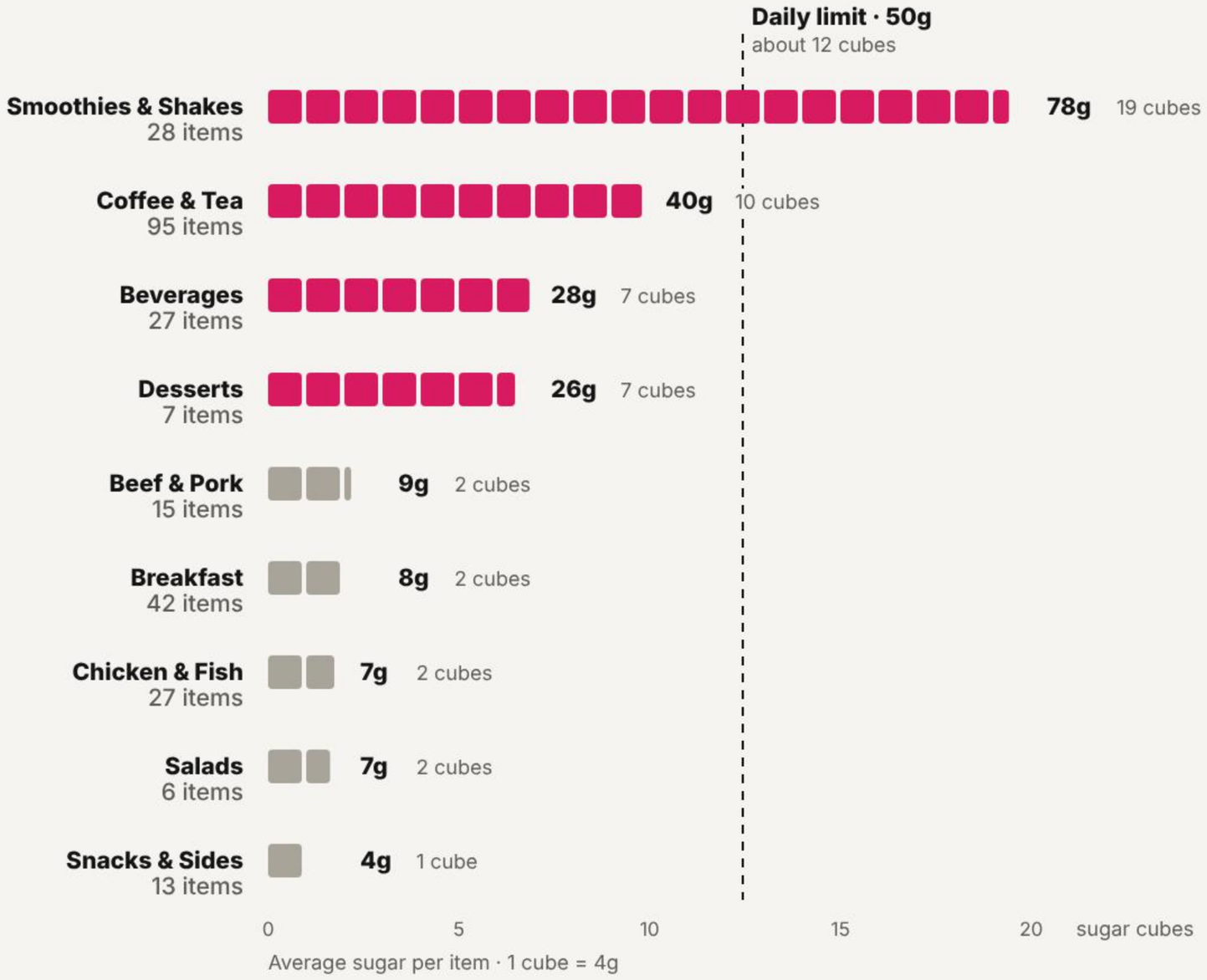
The average shake holds 78g, a day and a half of sugar. The average coffee drink holds 40g, more than the average soft drink at 28g. Food averages under 10g.

Average shake **78g**

KEY

- One sugar cube, 4g
- One sugar cube in a food category
- Daily limit, 50g, about 12 cubes

Each row is the average item in that category, drawn as sugar cubes.



Data: Nutrition Facts for McDonald's Menu (Kaggle, US menu, 260 items). Sugar limit: WHO guideline, under 10% of energy, about 50g on 2,000 kcal.

Same order, smaller or grilled

All 13 chicken dishes sold both ways lose 80 to 160 calories when grilled. A Small instead of a Large saves a median 130 calories and 21g of sugar.

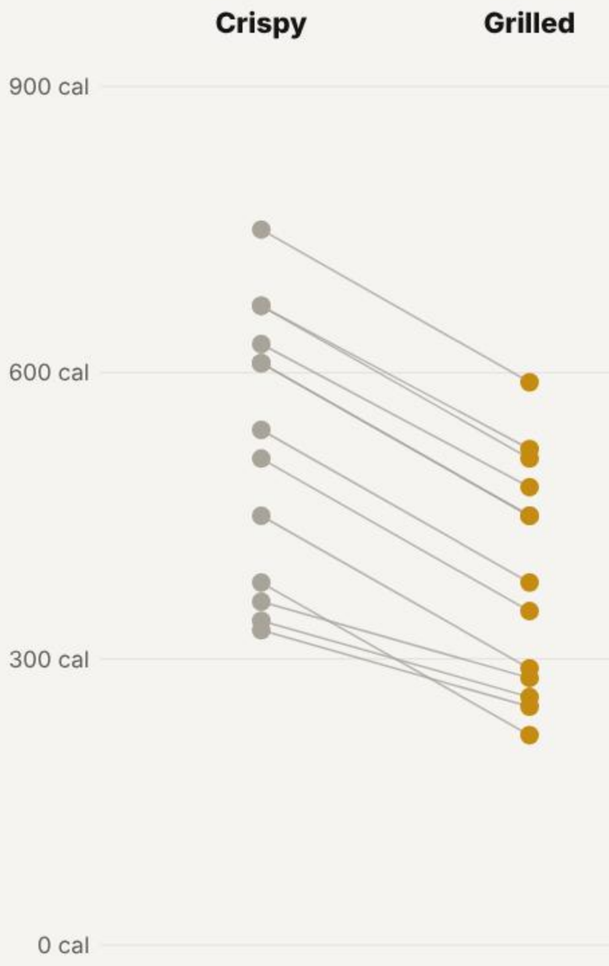
Calories saved per grilled dish

80–160

KEY

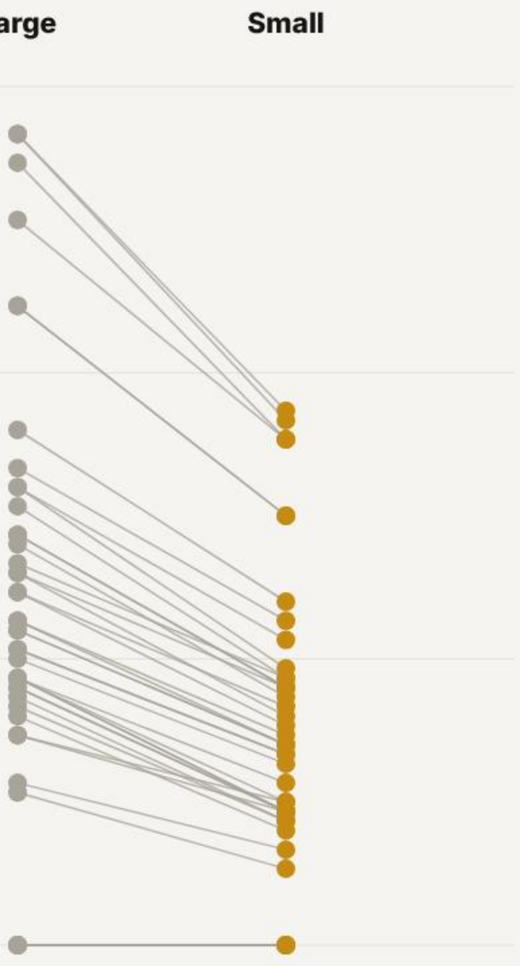
- What people order now
- The smarter version

13 chicken dishes sold both ways



Every dish drops: 80 to 160 cal

43 drinks sold in Small and Large



Median: 130 cal and 21g sugar

Flat lines: diet sodas, coffee, iced tea

Data: Nutrition Facts for McDonald's Menu (Kaggle, US menu, 260 items). Sugar limit: WHO guideline, under 10% of energy, about 50g on 2,000 kcal.

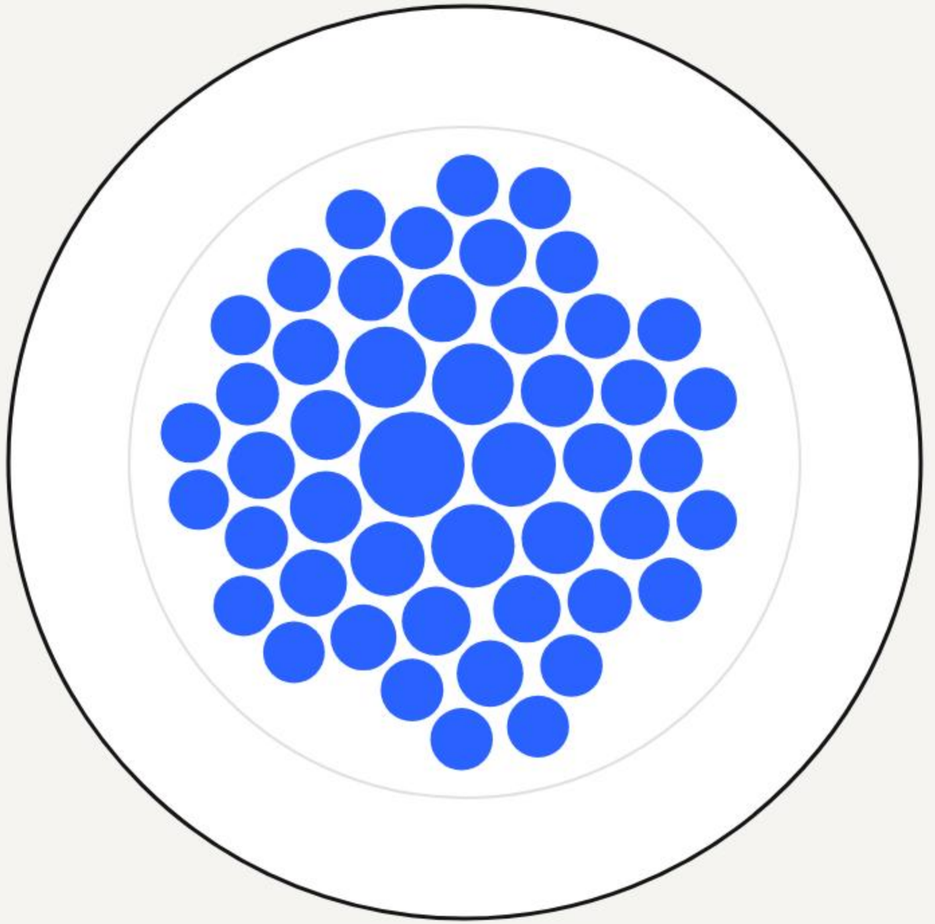
NOTES

PART 3 OF 3 · SALT

Salt.

48 dishes carry half a day of salt in one serving. On the plate, sugar is not the problem. Salt is.

PRESENTER 3 · 6 SLIDES



48 dishes on the plate

Each dot is one dish with half a day of salt (1,150mg or more) in a single serving. Bigger dot, more salt.

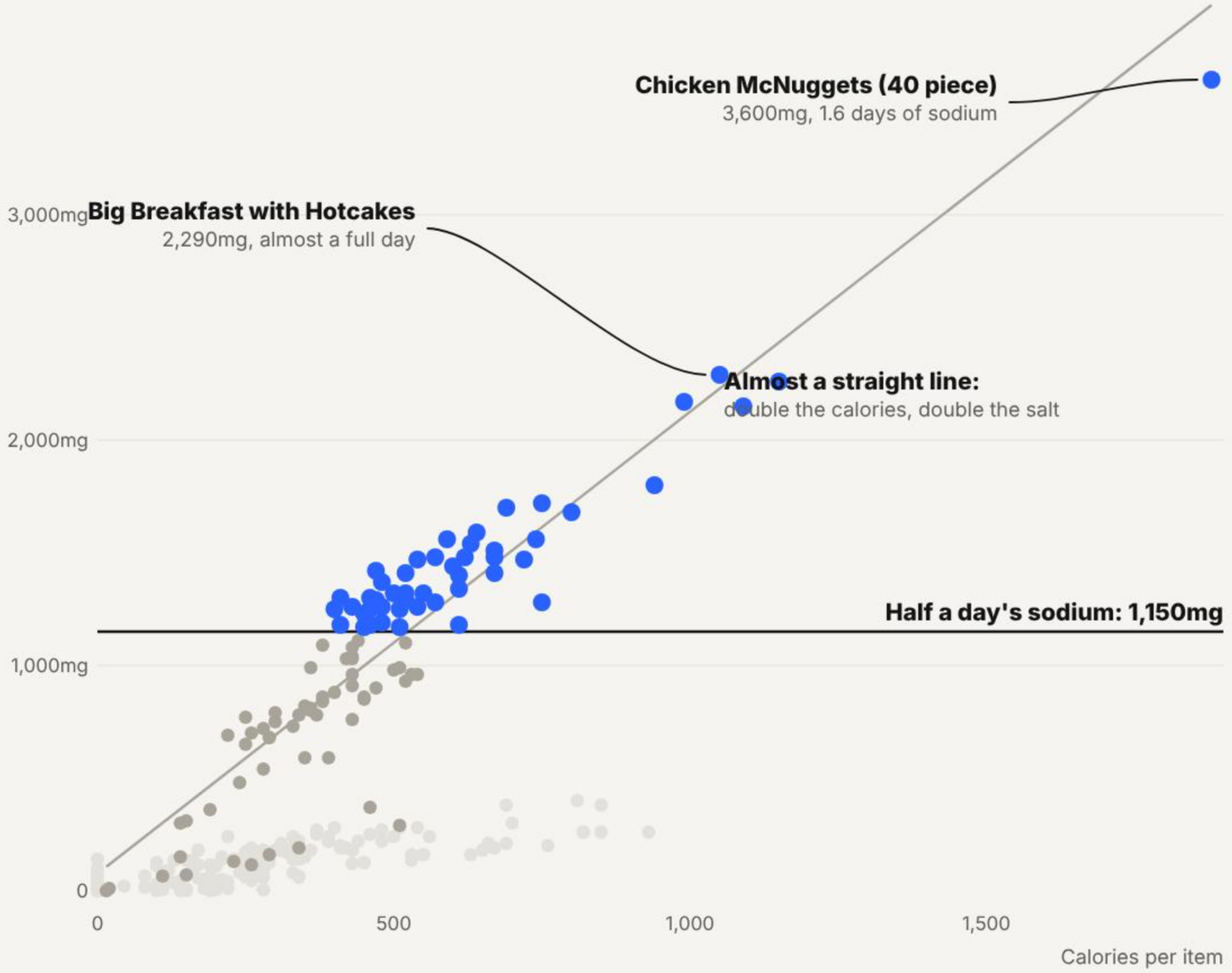
On the plate, the problem is salt

Food items barely carry sugar, but 48 of them hold half a day's sodium or more. The more calories on the plate, the saltier it gets.

Items with 1,150mg+ sodium **48**

KEY

- Food with 1,150mg+ sodium
- Other food
- Drinks & desserts



Data: Nutrition Facts for McDonald's Menu (Kaggle, US menu, 260 items). Sugar limit: WHO guideline, under 10% of energy, about 50g on 2,000 kcal.

NOTES

NOTES

Regulate the cup, not the counter

A ban removes all 260 items. Two warning labels would flag the 110 items that drive the problem and leave the other 150 alone.

Items flagged **110**

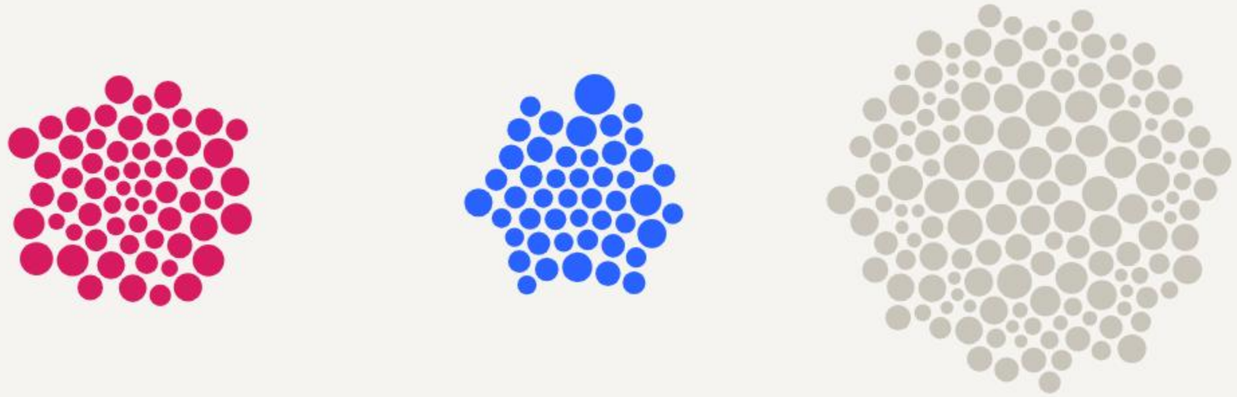
KEY

- Sugar over 50g
- Sodium 1,150mg or more
- No flag

Sugar over 50g
62 items, all in a cup

Sodium 1,150mg+
48 items, all food

No flag
150 items



MEASURE	REACHES	WHAT THE DATA SAYS
Small as the default drink size	**136 drinks**	Median 130 fewer calories and 21g less sugar per drink
Sugar warning at 50g+	**62 items**	Every one of them comes in a cup
Sodium warning at 1,150mg+	**48 items**	New York City's 2,300mg icon would flag only 1 item here
Grilled listed first on menu boards	**13 dishes**	80 to 160 fewer calories per dish

Precedents: New York City requires chain restaurants to show a salt-shaker icon next to items with 2,300mg of sodium or more. California makes water or plain milk the default drink in kids' meals (SB 1192).

Data: Nutrition Facts for McDonald's Menu (Kaggle, US menu, 260 items). Sugar limit: WHO guideline, under 10% of energy, about 50g on 2,000 kcal.

Pilot targeted rules before any ban

> Decision we ask for today: approve a six-month Small-by-default pilot with two or three chains.

Start where the data points: the drink cup and the salt on the plate. Measure what people actually order, then decide.

KEY

- Sugar flag
- Sodium flag
- No flag

NEXT STEPS

Pilot Small-by-default with two or three chains for six months.

Ask chains for sales data. A menu shows what is offered, not what is eaten.

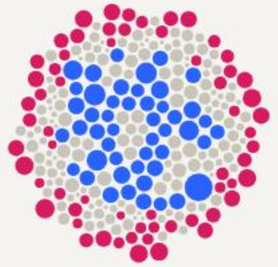
Repeat with local menus. Portions and recipes differ by country.

WHAT THIS DATA CAN'T TELL US

One chain, one menu. 260 McDonald's items, US nutrition facts.

No sales volumes. A rarely ordered shake counts as much as fries.

Thresholds are ours. 50g sugar and 1,150mg sodium follow WHO and US daily values.



SOURCES AND TOOLS

Data: Nutrition Facts for McDonald's Menu, Kaggle (US menu, 260 items)

Sugar limit: WHO Guideline on sugars intake for adults and children (2015)

Sodium warning: NYC Department of Health, Sodium Warning Rule

Kids' meal drinks: California Department of Public Health, SB 1192 fact sheet

Tools: Looker Studio dashboard and D3.js. Built with AI assistance (Claude); analysis and recommendations by Group 3.

Data: Nutrition Facts for McDonald's Menu (Kaggle, US menu, 260 items). Sugar limit: WHO guideline, under 10% of energy, about 50g on 2,000 kcal.

PART 3 · POLICY · WHAT TO ORDER INSTEAD

Same meal, a fraction of the sugar

Three common orders. Keep the main item, change the cup and the side. Nothing new has to go on the menu.

Sugar cubes saved, three meals **36**

KEY

- What people order
- Order this instead
- One sugar cube, 4g

Meals follow McDonald's own combos: main item, fries, drink. Nutrition from the same 260-item dataset.

SUGAR IN THE MEAL · ONE CUBE = 4G

1 · Big Mac Meal

Keep the Big Mac. Small fries, a no-sugar drink.

- **Big Mac · medium fries · medium Coke**
  1,070 cal · 64g sugar · 1,155mg sodium
  16 cubes
- **Big Mac · small fries · medium Diet Coke**
  760 cal · 9g sugar · 1,110mg sodium
  2 cubes
  saves 310 calories and 55g of sugar

2 · Crispy chicken meal

Grilled instead of crispy. Same sandwich, same bun.

- **Crispy chicken sandwich · medium fries · medium Coke**
  1,050 cal · 65g sugar · 1,185mg sodium
  16 cubes
- **Grilled chicken sandwich · small fries · medium Diet Coke**
  580 cal · 8g sugar · 970mg sodium
  2 cubes
  saves 470 calories and 57g of sugar

3 · Breakfast run

The caramel syrup alone is 8 cubes. Keep the latte, lose the syrup.

- **Sausage McMuffin with Egg · Hash Brown · medium caramel latte**
  940 cal · 50g sugar · 1,310mg sodium
  13 cubes
- **Egg McMuffin · Hash Brown · medium latte**
  660 cal · 18g sugar · 1,200mg sodium
  5 cubes
  saves 280 calories and 32g of sugar

Data: Nutrition Facts for McDonald's Menu (Kaggle, US menu, 260 items). Sugar limit: WHO guideline, under 10% of energy, about 50g on 2,000 kcal.

AFTER THE MEAL · ONE DECISION

Approve a six-month Small-by-default pilot.

Start small, measure what people actually order, then decide. Madrid keeps its menu and loses the sugar.

> Thank you for listening. Questions welcome.

WHAT THE DATA SAYS

- 62 items over 50g of sugar. Every one comes in a cup.
- 48 dishes with half a day of sodium. Every one is food.
- 150 items touched by neither flag. A ban would remove them too.

SUGAR · REGULATE THE CUP

62

items over the daily limit in one serving. All of them drinks or desserts. A sugar warning at 50g reaches every one.

SALT · WARN, DON'T BAN

48

dishes with half a day of sodium. All of them food. A sodium icon at 1,150mg, as New York does at 2,300mg.